



An Roinn Dlí agus Cirt,
Gnóthaí Baile agus Imirce
Department of Justice,
Home Affairs and Migration

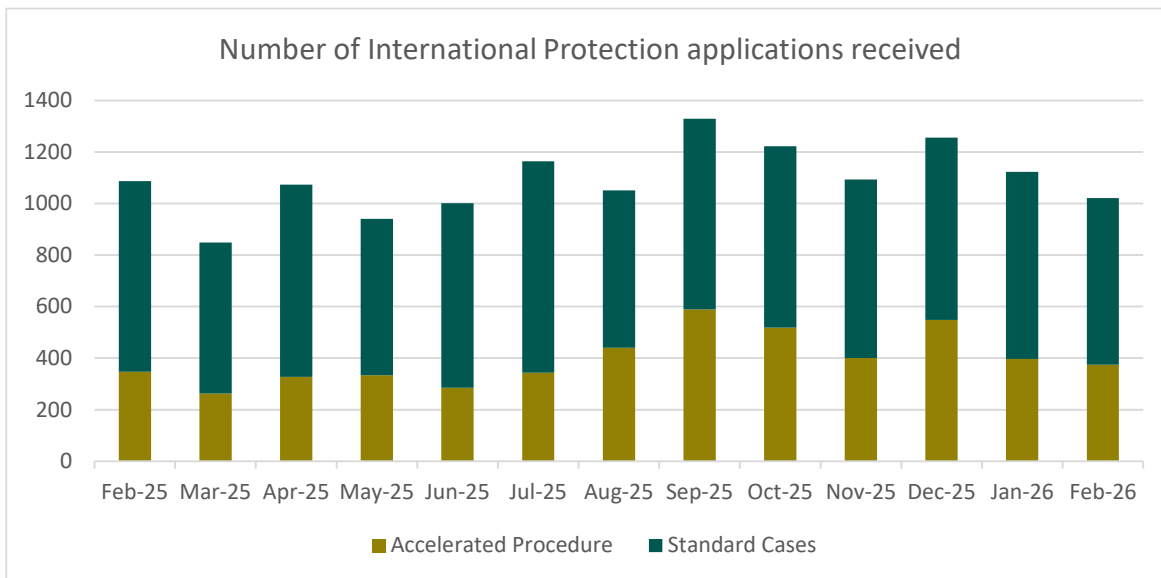
International Protection: February 2026

Executive Summary

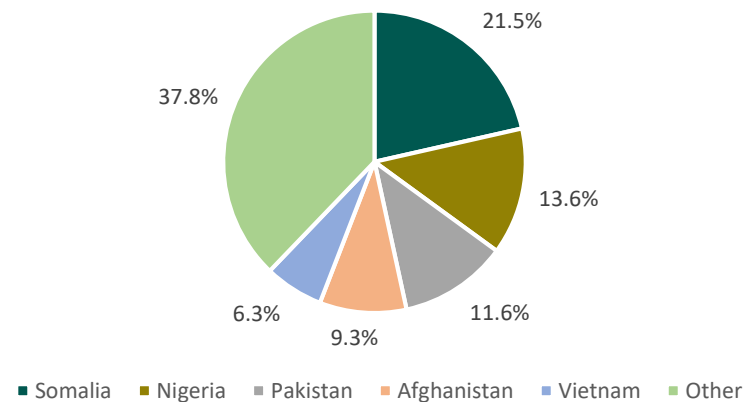
The figures in this dashboard were extracted on the 9th March 2026. These are operational figures and subject to change. The charts below refer to key points in the asylum process. A flow chart is provided at the end of the pack that sets out this process. Overall, for February 2026:

- Compared to last year, the number of asylum applications has reduced slightly. In February 2026 there were 1,021 applications compared to 1,088 in February 2025.
- The main countries of origin for 2026 are: Somalia (460 applications), Nigeria (291), Pakistan (248), Afghanistan (199) and Vietnam (135).
- The number of applications pending in the IPO has been reducing since the end of September 2024, when it stood at 23,863. As of February this year, there were 14,332 applications pending
- Compared to last year, there has been an decrease in the number of applications where the IPO made a recommendation or otherwise closed off a case. In February 2026, 1,412 cases were closed off compared to 1,620 in February 2025
- The median time to make a decision for standard cases has increased slightly. In February 2026, the median processing time to determination was 79 weeks (compared to 74 weeks in August 2025 and 76 weeks in November 2025)
- The number of staff in the IPO has increased slightly to 616 at the end of February 2026
- Of those applications where a final decision was made in February 2026 (for example, after the outcomes of appeals were considered), 61% of decisions were refusals, 2% permission to remain, and 37% were international protection grants

Applications and Main Nationalities

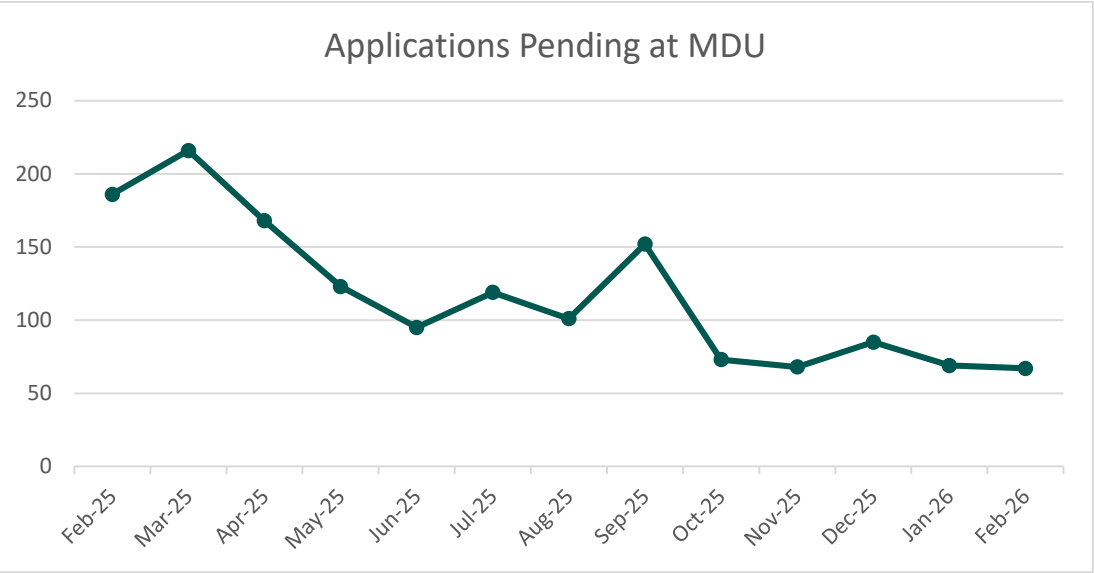
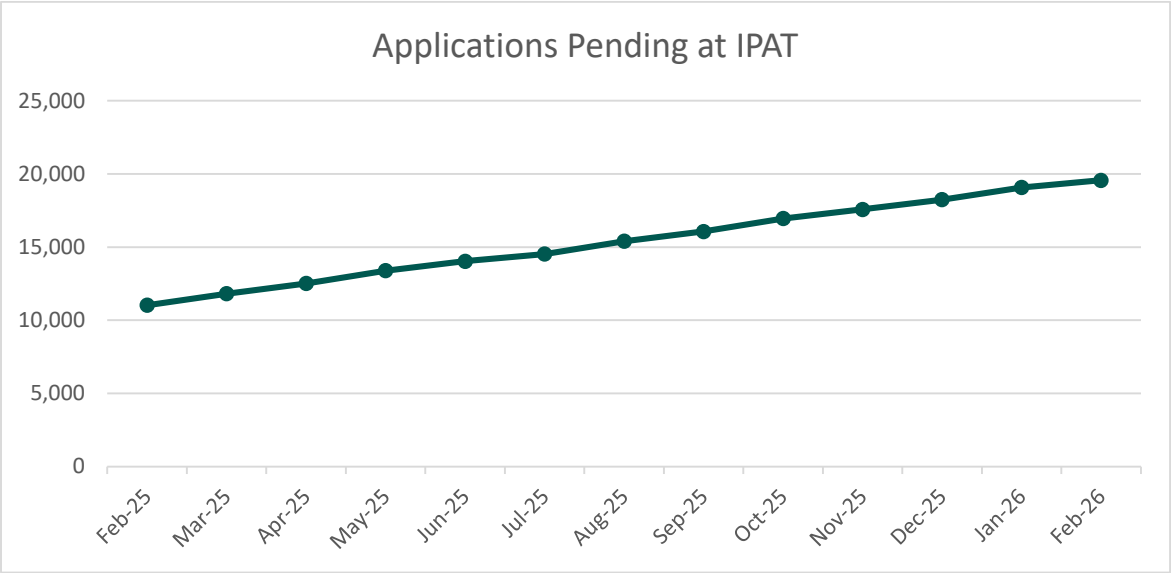
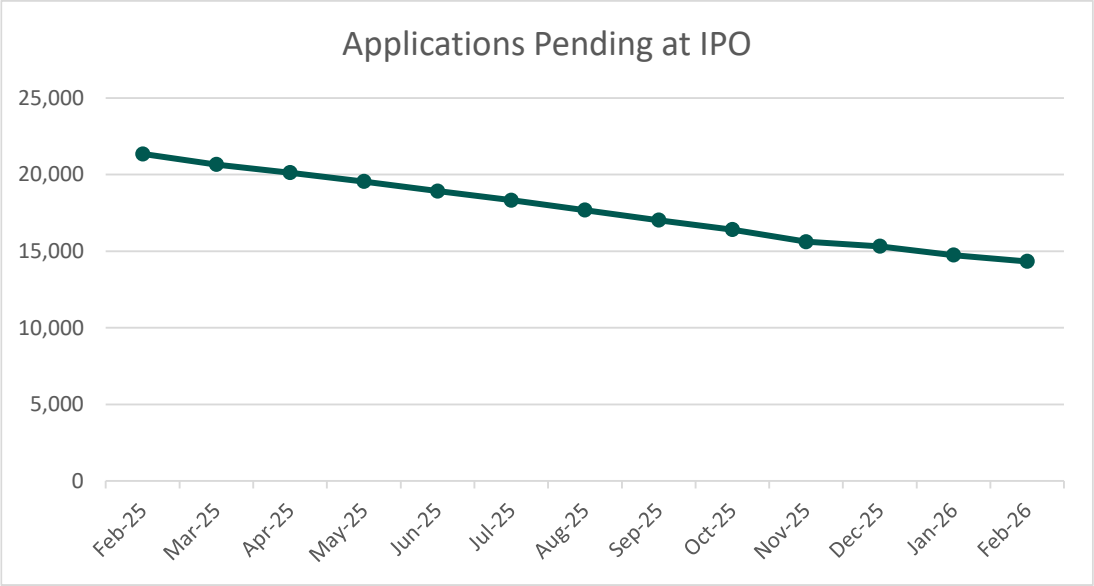


Top 5 Nationalities for International Protection applications in 2026 (up to end of February)



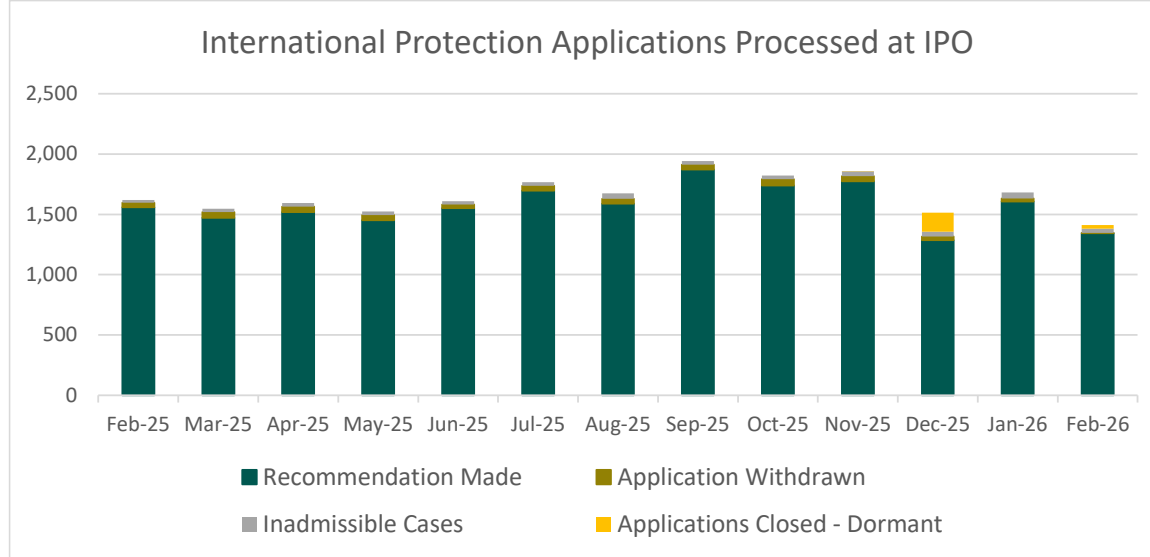
- In February 2026 there were 1,021 applications received for asylum. This is down from 1,088 last February
- The total number of applications in February 2026 that fell under accelerated procedure was 375 (which represents 37% of all applicants)
- The main countries of origin for 2026 are: Somalia (460 applications), Nigeria (291), Pakistan (248), Afghanistan (199) and Vietnam (135)

Pending International Protection Applications

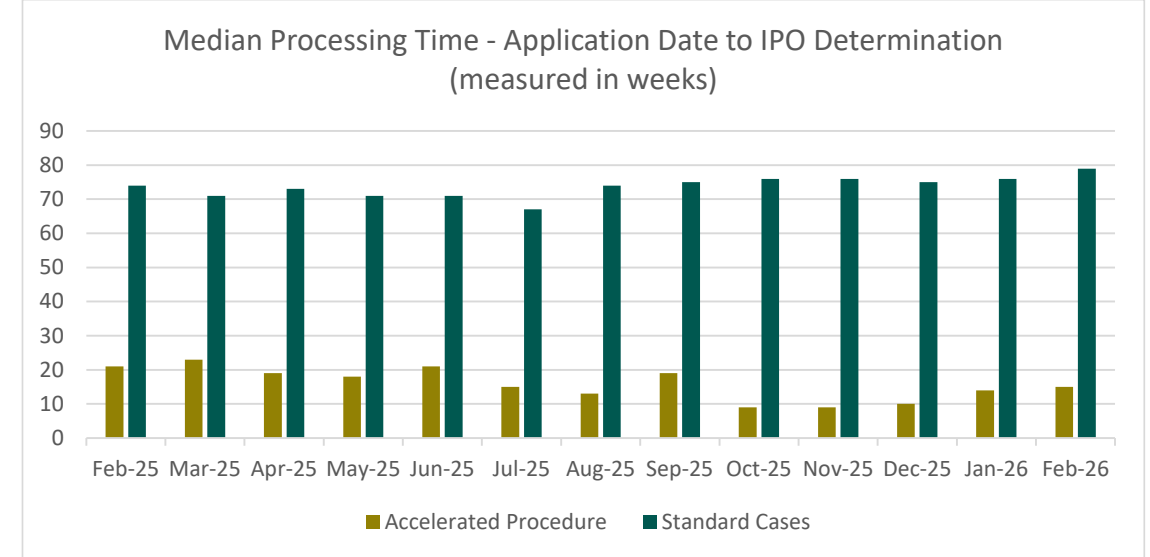


- The number of applications pending in the IPO is 14,332. The numbers have been reducing since the end of September 2024
- The number of pending applications for IPAT has been trending upwards. In February 2026, there were 19,570 applications pending
- The pending figure for MDU at the end of February 2026 is 67

International Protection: Applications Processed and Median Processing Time

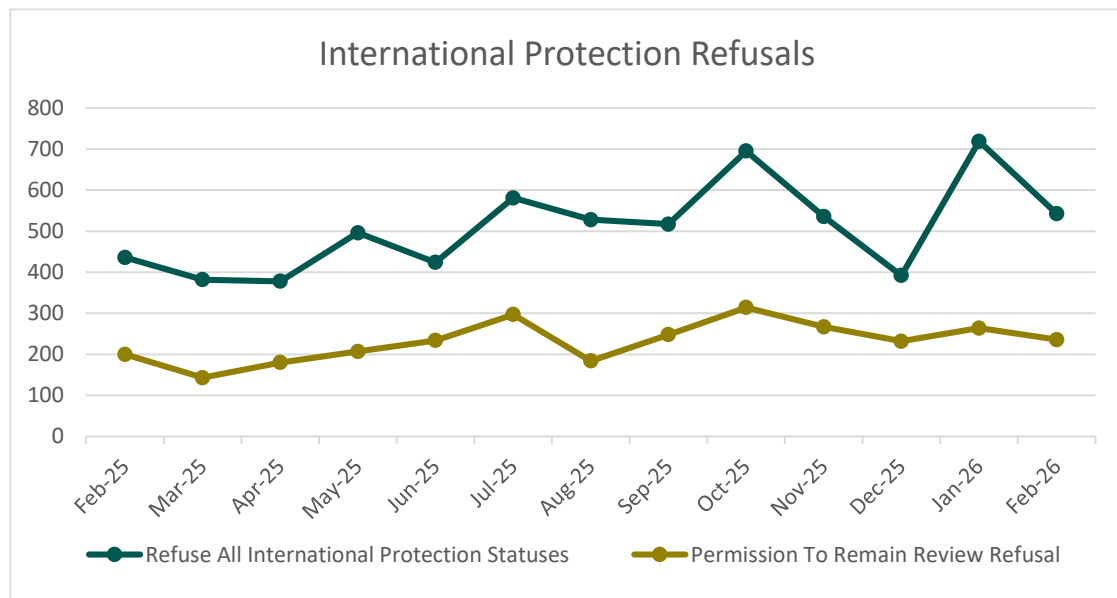
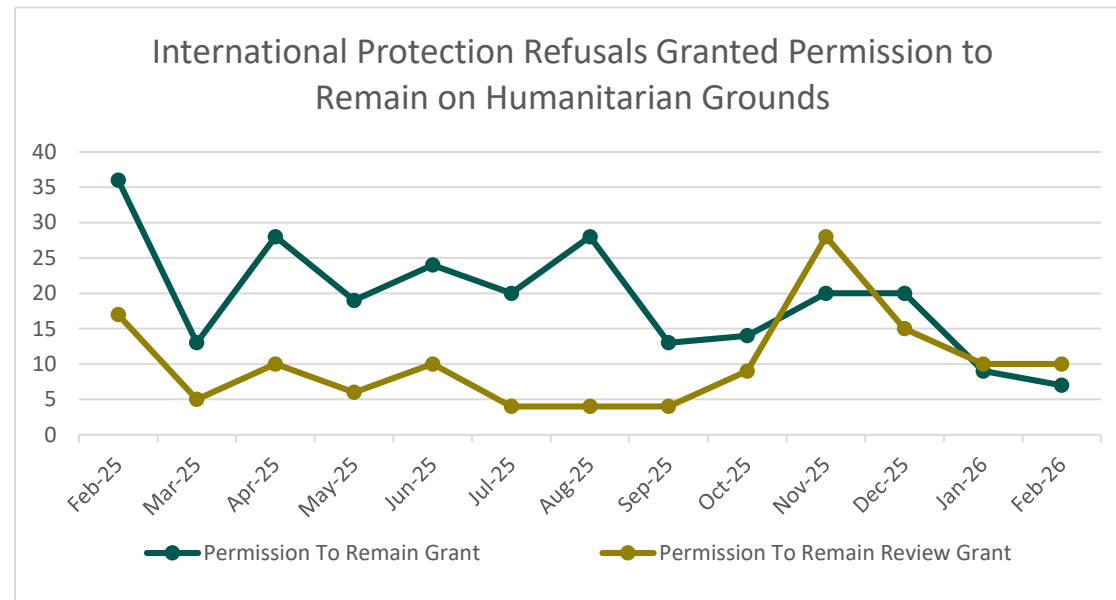
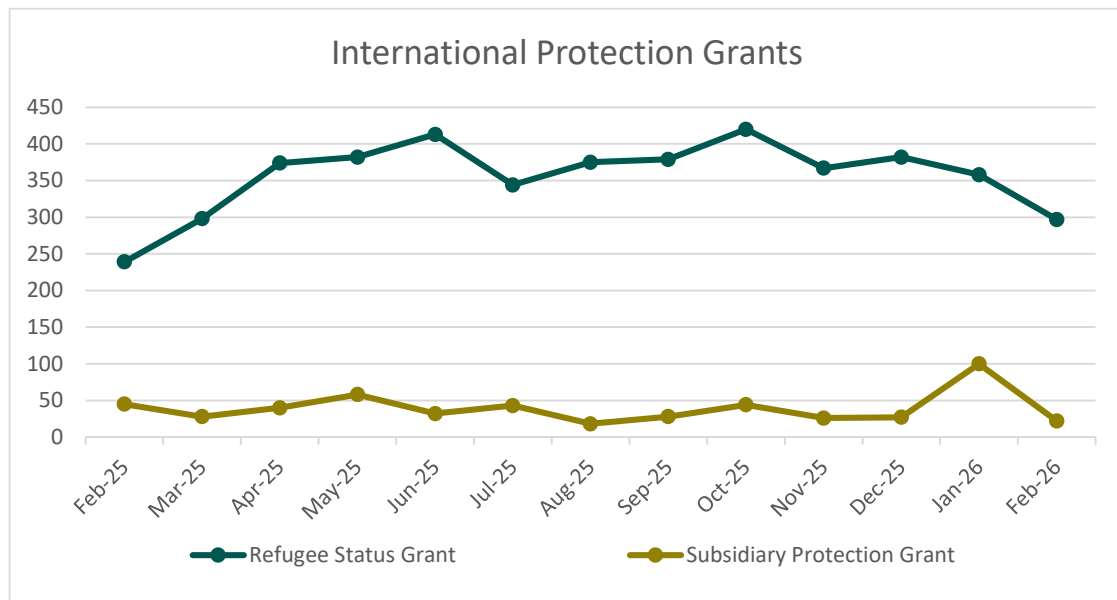


- This table is counting Recommendations Made, Applications Deemed Inadmissible, Applications Withdrawn and Dormant Applications
- In February 2026, 1,412 cases were closed off. This is down from 1,514 in December 2025 and 1,681 in January 2026
- 2026 YTD applications processed were 3,093 (an 8.9% decrease on 3,396 applications processed for 2025)



- The median processing time to determining an outcome to an asylum application had been remaining steady for Standard Cases. The median processing time for cases under the Accelerated Procedure have decreased compared to the first half of 2025.
- In February 2026, the median processing time to determination for standard cases was 79 weeks (up from 74 weeks in August 2025 and 76 weeks in November 2025)
- For accelerated procedure only, the median processing time was 15 weeks in February 2026, up from 10 weeks in December 2025 and 14 weeks in January 2026

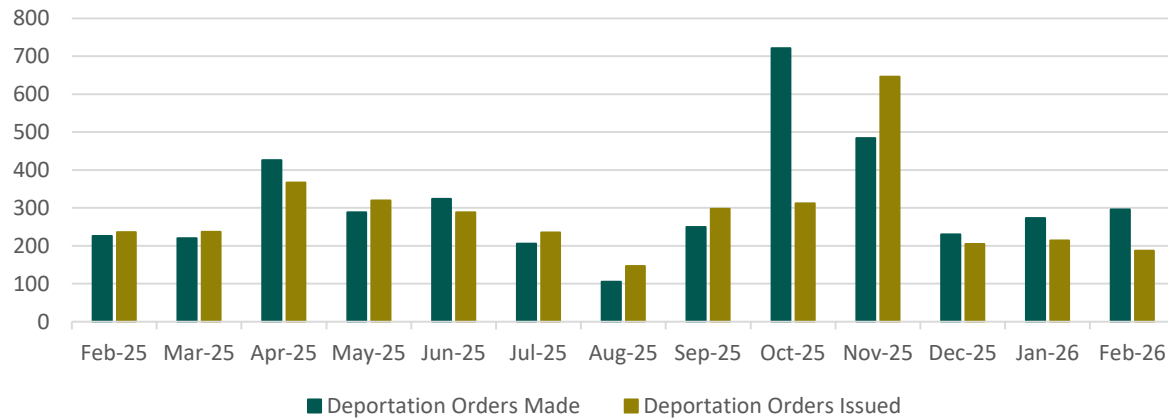
International Protection Decisions – Granted and Refused



- In February 2026, of those applications where a final decision was made (for example, after taking into account appeals), 297 were given refugee status grant and 22 subsidiary protection grant (319 in total). There is significant variation in these decisions over the last few months with no clear trend
- Of those who were refused refugee status and subsidiary protection, 7 were given Permission to Remain on humanitarian grounds with 10 on a Permission to Remain Review Grant. There is significant variation in these decisions over the last few months with no clear trend
- There were 543 refusals for International Protection Statuses and 236 for Permission to Remain Review
- Overall, for February 2026, 61% of decisions were refusals, 2% permission to remain, and 37% were international protection grants

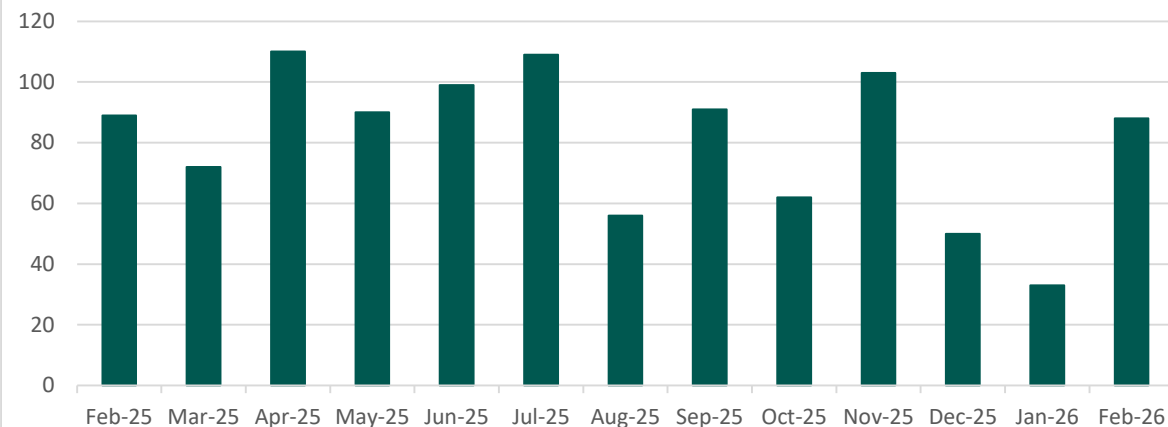
Deportation Orders and Enforcement/Removals

Deportation Orders where person had a previous International Protection application

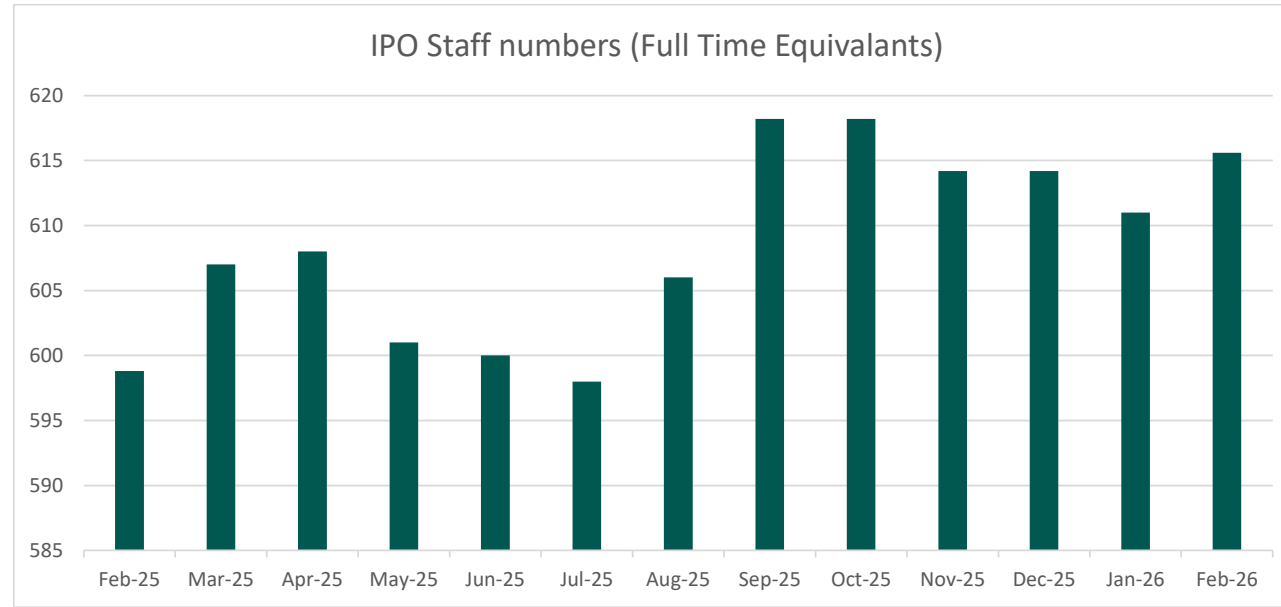


- For February 2026 the number of deportation orders made/signed (where a person had a previous asylum application) was 296 and the number of deportation orders issued was 187. For January 2026, the figures were 273 and 214, and for December 2025, the figures were 230 and 205, respectively
- For February 2026 the number of removals was 88

Enforcements and Returns where person had a previous International Protection application



IPO Staff number (Full-Time Equivalents)



- The number of staff in the IPO has started levelling off
- In February 2025 there were 599 FTEs in IPO. This number has been slowly trending upwards with some fluctuations, to 614 December 2025 and 611 in January 2026.
- At the end of February 2026, the IPO had 616 FTE staff



Appendix

Methodology

Pending International Protection Applications

- IPO – Data sourced from Lotus Notes
- IPAT – Data sourced from Lotus Notes
- MDU – Data sourced from AISIP. Pending figure does not include legacy cases – the legacy data has been captured in such a way that it cannot be accurately reported on

International Protection: Interviews and Applications Processed

- Data sourced from Lotus Notes

International Protection Applications Processing Times

- Data sourced from Lotus Notes
- Applicants to whom section 38(5) of the International Protection Act 2015 applies (failure to co-operate) are included in the calculations
- Where an interview took place after a case was reactivated the reactivation date is used as the application date, otherwise the original application date was used for the processing time calculation
- The median calculation is used for processing time at IPO as there are significant outliers in the length of time asylum applications can spend in processing. This is typically due to lengthy procedures such as judicial reviews which are complex and time consuming by their nature, and which are also outside of the remit and control of the IPO during that part of the process. The median is a more accurate measure of the time spent by the IPO in processing applications.

Methodology

International Protection Decisions – Granted and Refused

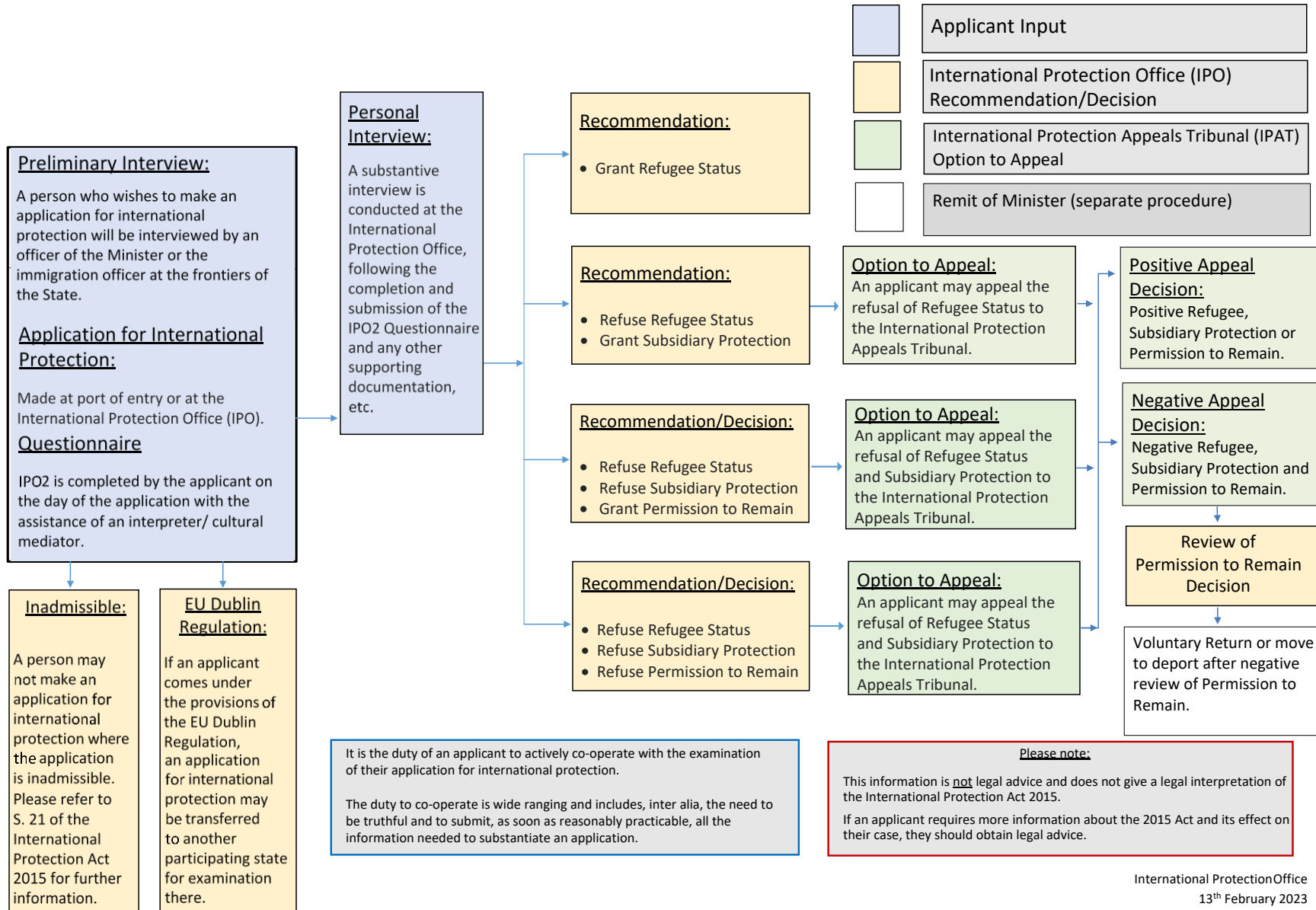
- Quashed decisions and Revocation of Status are not included
- Decision figures include international protection decisions (IPDN) and legacy application types
- Each applicant is represented once in the granted and refused tables
 - For example, if a person is refused refugee status but is granted subsidiary protection they are recorded once in the tables as a subsidiary protection grant. This is to more clearly represent the overall numbers of granted and refused applicants, and to avoid double counting of individuals where they are refused one type of status but are granted another.
- Some of the applicants who have been granted permission to remain are also included in the 'Refuse All International Protection Statuses' category of the refusals table. Permission to remain is a humanitarian permission. In order to be considered for permission to remain you must first have been refused international protection. On slide 7, the 'International Protection Refusals Granted Permission to Remain on Humanitarian Grounds' chart is a combination of applicants still in the asylum process and applicants who have finished the process. The 'International Protection Refusals' chart includes only those applicants who have finished the asylum process.
- Where a revocation occurs the original grant is removed from the figures for the month the permission was originally granted. For example, if an application was granted in January but subsequently revoked later in the year the January figure is updated to remove the grant

Deportation Orders and Enforcement/Removals

- Data for the International Protection Deportation Order (IPDP) application type is sourced from AISIP. All other data is sourced from Lotus Notes

General Overview of Process under International Protection Act 2015

General Overview of Process under International Protection Act 2015



Data Tables (1)

International Protection Office - Applications Received

	Feb-25	Mar-25	Apr-25	May-25	Jun-25	Jul-25	Aug-25	Sep-25	Oct-25	Nov-25	Dec-25	Jan-26	Feb-26
Accelerated Procedure	347	263	327	333	285	344	440	589	519	400	549	397	375
Standard Cases	741	586	747	608	717	821	611	740	704	694	707	726	646

International Protection Office – Top 5 Nationality Applications

Top 5 nationalities 2026 to date	Applications	%
Somalia	460	21.5%
Nigeria	291	13.6%
Pakistan	248	11.6%
Afghanistan	199	9.3%
Vietnam	135	6.3%
Other	811	37.8%
Total	2144	

Data Tables (2)

International Protection Office - Pending Applications

IPO Pending	Feb-25	Mar-25	Apr-25	May-25	Jun-25	Jul-25	Aug-25	Sep-25	Oct-25	Nov-25	Dec-25	Jan-26	Feb-26
IP Pending	21,343	20,655	20,122	19,551	18,922	18,323	17,676	17,021	16,402	15,620	15,315	14,741	14,332
Leg Pending	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0

International Protection Appeals Tribunal - Pending Applications

	Feb-25	Mar-25	Apr-25	May-25	Jun-25	Jul-25	Aug-25	Sep-25	Oct-25	Nov-25	Dec-25	Jan-26	Feb-26
IPAT Pending	11028	11814	12517	13393	14035	14529	15397	16067	16958	17579	18243	19076	19570

Ministerial Decisions Unit - Pending Applications

MDU Pending	Feb-25	Mar-25	Apr-25	May-25	Jun-25	Jul-25	Aug-25	Sep-25	Oct-25	Nov-25	Dec-25	Jan-26	Feb-26
Total	186	216	168	123	95	119	101	152	73	68	85	69	67

Data Tables (3)

International Protection Office – Processed Cases

	Feb-25	Mar-25	Apr-25	May-25	Jun-25	Jul-25	Aug-25	Sep-25	Oct-25	Nov-25	Dec-25	Jan-26	Feb-26
Recommendation Made	1559	1471	1520	1452	1551	1697	1588	1873	1740	1775	1287	1607	1343
Application Withdrawn	38	47	43	41	31	40	40	40	51	41	29	25	3
Inadmissible Cases	23	28	31	31	27	31	45	28	31	40	41	49	36
Applications Closed - Dormant	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	4	157	0	30

International Protection Office Median Process Time – Application Date to IPO Determination (measured in weeks)

	Feb-25	Mar-25	Apr-25	May-25	Jun-25	Jul-25	Aug-25	Sep-25	Oct-25	Nov-25	Dec-25	Jan-26	Feb-26
Accelerated Procedure	21	23	19	18	21	15	13	19	9	9	10	14	15
Standard Cases	74	71	73	71	71	67	74	75	76	76	75	76	79

Data Tables (4)

International Protection Decisions – Grants

	Feb-25	Mar-25	Apr-25	May-25	Jun-25	Jul-25	Aug-25	Sep-25	Oct-25	Nov-25	Dec-25	Jan-26	Feb-26
Refugee Status Grant	239	298	374	382	413	344	375	379	420	367	382	358	297
Subsidiary Protection Grant	45	28	40	58	32	43	18	28	44	26	27	100	22
Permission To Remain Grant	36	13	28	19	24	20	28	13	14	20	20	9	7
Permission To Remain Review Grant	17	5	10	6	10	4	4	4	9	28	15	10	10

International Protection Decisions – Refusals

	Feb-25	Mar-25	Apr-25	May-25	Jun-25	Jul-25	Aug-25	Sep-25	Oct-25	Nov-25	Dec-25	Jan-26	Feb-26
Refuse All International Protection Statuses	436	382	378	496	424	581	528	517	695	536	392	719	543
Permission To Remain Review Refusals	200	143	180	207	234	297	184	248	314	267	232	264	236

Data Tables (5)

Deportation Orders where person had a previous International Protection application

	Feb-25	Mar-25	Apr-25	May-25	Jun-25	Jul-25	Aug-25	Sep-25	Oct-25	Nov-25	Dec-25	Jan-26	Feb-26
Deportation Orders Made	226	220	426	288	324	206	105	250	721	484	230	273	296
Deportation Orders Issued	236	237	367	320	288	235	147	298	312	646	205	214	187

Deportation Enforcements and Returns where person had a previous International Protection application

Enforcements/Returns	Feb-25	Mar-25	Apr-25	May-25	Jun-25	Jul-25	Aug-25	Sep-25	Oct-25	Nov-25	Dec-25	Jan-26	Feb-26
Total	89	72	110	90	99	109	56	91	62	103	50	33	88

Data Tables (6)

International Protection Office Staff Numbers (Full-Time Equivalents)

	Feb-25	Mar-25	Apr-25	May-25	Jun-25	Jul-25	Aug-25	Sep-25	Oct-25	Nov-25	Dec-25	Jan-26	Feb-26
IPO Staffing Levels	598.8	607	608	601	600	598	606	618.2	618.2	614.2	614.2	611	615.6